Why the Month Day Format is not only absurd but also a wrong date format – a proof by contradiction

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Abstract

The date above is wrong. It is not a correct representation of the actual date, which is 2026-03-11, or the 11th of March, 2026. This is why. Therefore, please retire this date format so that we all have good dates.

Keywords: Worst, date, format, ever, proof

1 Introduction

Many people ask themselves, *What is the best date*? While answers may vary, as this might be subjective, within this article, the author proves that the date as displayed above (*March 11*) *is wrong*, making it the worst of the common dates. Also called the *'American absurdity'* (MineralPlunder, 2019), Month Day is widely recognised as the worst date format. That it is also objectively wrong is proven in this article.

2 Proof

Assume 11th of March, 2026 is today's date, and let's agree this is correct. Let's also consider Mary, who (famously) has a little lamb (and disregard that we don't know how the lamb feels about being possessed by Mary).

Mary's little lamb implies the little lamb of Mary. Let's apply something similar to the correct date, the 11th of March, which, recall, is a true statement.

$$\text{little lamb of Mary} = \text{Mary's little lamb}$$
$$\text{Mary's little lamb} = \text{little lamb of Mary}$$
$$11^{\text{th}} \text{ of March} = \text{March's } 11^{\text{th}}$$

It becomes evident that the 11th of March is indeed the 11th (day) of March.

Now, take the case of March 11 in order to prove by contradiction and suppose:

$$11^{\text{th}} \text{ of March} = \text{March 11}$$
$$\text{But as:}$$
$$\text{little lamb of Mary} \neq \text{Mary little lamb}$$

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Given *Mary little lamb* is so ambiguous that you may wonder if the author is under the influence, one can confidently refute the claim that March 11 is a valid date.

3 Conclusion

We can confidently conclude that March 11 is not equivalent to today's date, which is 2026-03-11, the best date format IMHO, and International Organization for Standardization agrees with me. Given the proof in this paper, we should retire the Month Day Year date format, once and for all.

References

International Organization for Standardization (2019). Date and time – Representations for information interchange Part 1: Basic rules. Standard, International Organization for Standardization, Geneva, CH.

MineralPlunder (2019). A correction of fixed version of a certain diagram comparing pyramids of date formats. `https://www.reddit.com/r/ISO8601/comments/aafikk/a_correction_of_fixed_version_of_a_certain/`. [Accessed 2026-03-11].